As the army chief, I assiduously built up rapport and a working relationship with the political leadership and the bureaucracy at the national level, based on mutual trust and healthy respect for each other. Consequently, there was greater synergy. I never had a problem of accessibility to the highest level of the national leadership. Whenever my views were sought, they were given in a frank and forthright manner, keeping in mind the national interest. Even though we disagreed on occasions, there was no acrimony. We faced some tricky situations, which were overcome in a sagacious and mature manner.

Ongoing inductions in the Indian Army have substantially enhanced our night-fighting capability at the level of the individual soldier as well as for major equipment like tanks, guns and other weapon systems. We have also inducted cutting-edge technology in the field of netcentric warfare not only within our service but also in conjunction with other services in an environment of increasing reliance on interoperability. Still, the pace of modernization of the Indian Army needs to be hastened.

We have also achieved very satisfying results in counterterrorism operations and the ongoing proxy war. During my tenure as the chief, the attrition ratios in J&K regarding casualties incurred by our troops vis-à-vis the terrorists had improved considerably in our favour. Simultaneously, there has been a perceptible drop in violence levels in the state. Elections have been conducted peacefully and there is an overall yearning for peace. The tide has successfully turned for us in the proxy war, which is evident through the increased levels of intelligence that is available from the locals and the spurt in the number of surrenders.

There is also an overall improvement in the security scenario in the northeast. The people have rejected violence by secessionist groups as a means of achieving their political goals. Furthermore, militant organizations like the NSCN, the ULFA, and the PLA of Nagaland, Assam and Manipur respectively, have been pushed out from their sanctuaries in Bangladesh due to the rapid improvement in our relations. We have been successful in persuading Myanmar also to put pressure on these unlawful outfits, which have created